

THE RECESSION PROMPTED MANY GRADUATES TO SIT OUT OF THE PLACEMENT PROCESS AND START THEIR OWN VENTURES



Centre, ISB. These business plans are not only techno-centric ones but include a wide spectrum ranging from rural supply chain or agriculture to healthcare and manufacturing. The icing on the cake is that B-schools have started thinking beyond the individual and are moving towards inclusive growth. The Tata Institute of Social Sciences (TISS) has launched an MBA in Entrepreneurship Development. "This course teaches the aspirants how to manage the resources of the poor and thus facilitate wealth creation among the marginalised," says S. Parasuraman, director, TISS. The enthusiasm among the students is no less and is corroborated by the fact that more than 2,000 applications are received for 500 seats that the college has to offer.

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WITH PROMOTION OF LEADERSHIP SKILLS, THE EMPHASIS IS ALSO SHIFTING TOWARDS INDIAN OR ASIAN CASE STUDIES TO ILLUSTRATE SUCCESS STORIES.

wards Indian or Asian case studies to illustrate success stories. There was a time when relevant research was almost non-existent in India and students had to make do with the Western examples. Indian management researchers were hardly published in international journals as most of the domestic data was dismissed as spurious. But the pariah dog treatment is fast fading away. India's economic success has ensured that this trend is reversed, slowly yet steadily. "We invite local businessmen to the classroom and write case studies on Indian entrepreneurs,"

says Tanuka. At most of the IIMs, at least 40 per cent of the case studies are from India.

For those desirous of greater domain knowledge, the good news is here. Specialisation is the buzz word with the new-age MBAs. The Indian Institute of Forest Management, Bhopal, and Indian Institute of Foreign Trade, Delhi, have been renowned for their academic quality and infrastructure for a long time. But many more institutes have cropped up, offering courses in niche areas such as retail, agri-business and hospital administration. Indian colleges